

2. Candidate Key

- A candidate key is an attribute or set of an attribute which can uniquely identify a tuple.
- A candidate key is a **minimal super key**; or a Super key with no redundant attributes.
 - ▣ It is called a minimal super key because we select a candidate key from a set of super key such that selected candidate key is the minimum attribute required to uniquely identify the table
- Candidate keys are defined as distinct set of attributes from which **primary key can be selected**

Candidate keys are not allowed to have NULL values